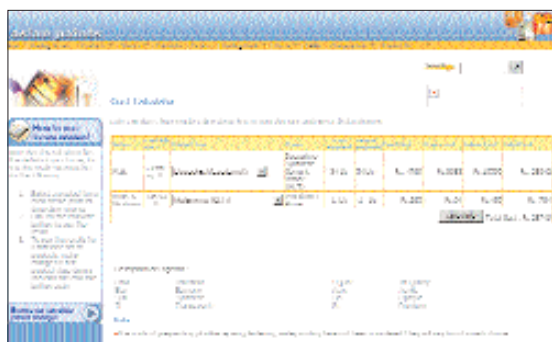




Calculate painting costs with the painting cost calculator at Asianpaints.com

your home such as maximising your kitchen storage space, selecting carpets or choosing the lighting for your home. The Web site of Ikea, the home décor vendor (www.ikea-usa.com), has interactive guides on storage at home, checklists and tips for your home. You can also take a look at some great ideas for home decor as well as furnishing.

Estimating material costs

Once you've decided on what exactly you want, the next step is to get the materials required. And if you are remembering those times you did up your house and mentally worked out the amount of material you needed, only to find later that you had bought too little or too much, then worry not. Use the home planning tools at Hdfcrealty.com to help you estimate the material you need. Planners like the Kitchen Tool or the Bedroom Tool will help you work out how much it's going to cost you to remodel that particular room based on its dimensions, fixtures such as the size of doors or windows and room layout.

Most of the rates (such as those for painting or room accessories) are calculated as per the products available on the site. You can do all this

effortlessly by simply filling out a form with the relevant information. Tools such as the Paint Calculator and the Tile Calculator let you plan the quantity of building material you need according to your room dimensions and also work out the cost.

Need a home improvement loan? You can calculate your estimate and use the loan calculator to figure out your monthly EMI and even apply for a loan online.

Homecentral (www.homecentral.com) also has a good range of tools and calculators including a guide to selecting the right kind of paint for different interior and exterior surfaces, whether it's metal or concrete, based on considerations such as wear and tear and what you'll be using to clean the surface. There's even a wallpaper estimator and an adhesive selector among other tools.

'Mera wala cream' online

Baffled about the perfect shade of 'mera wala cream' for your living room? www.asianpaints.com offers a range of shades on the site's shade catalogue.

Asian Paints also has a home decor section with tips and useful information about choosing the right colour scheme. It also has a tool that lets you select the right kind of paint for the surface you need painted. Read up on information about the paints in their product range such as the finish and drying time, method of application and directions for use.

The site even has a visualising tool: just click

Design a Room Online

Want to rearrange your room, from furniture and potted plants to flooring? Visualising in your mind's eye how you want your room to look is not so easy and you may end up with the backbreaking task of pushing furniture back and forth.

You can now play around with different arrangements and colours with interactive room designers. Online tools like the one at <http://javaboutique.internet.com/Design-a-Room> help you visualise the layout of your room. It's quite basic and lets you define the dimensions of different rooms such as the kitchen, bathroom or living room and lets you add a few pieces of furniture, doors and windows. You can set the size of furniture (basically just shapes) and move it around the way you want. You can also choose furniture that's already there in the list or create your own.

One of the best room planners can be found at Homestore.com ([\[store.com/Decorate/Multimedia/Room_Planner\]\(http://store.com/Decorate/Multimedia/Room_Planner\)\). You can design any kind of room, indoor or outdoor space in homes or offices. Add fixtures such as doors, windows, walls, dividers, fireplaces, etc. You can even experiment with flooring—different designs](http://www.home-</p>
</div>
<div data-bbox=)



Rearrange your furniture virtually with this handy room planner

and patterns for wooden, marble, stone floors as well as ceramic tile designs, carpets and linoleum.

Homestore has quite a wide range of furniture loaded to suit every room such as kitchen, living room, bathrooms and accessories such as televisions, potted plants, sculpture, rugs and bookcases so that you get the feel of designing a home, not just pushing shapes around. You can set and adjust the size of the furniture with your mouse or rotate it to place it exactly where you want. You can save your room layout and even print it out for use as a guideline when redecorating your home.

Want to figure out a good floor and wall combination? Try out this room viewer at <http://www.armstrong.com/roomviewer/index.jsp>. You can't rearrange furniture at this site but you can select pictures of the interiors of rooms and play around with different types of wall shades, floorings and cabinet finishes and save your pictures.